

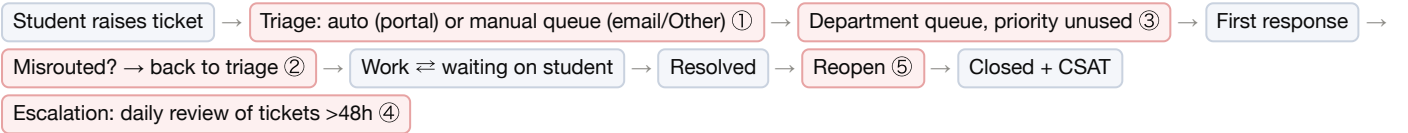
1 · One-page problem brief

Client: Student Services Helpdesk of a residential engineering college (about 1,800 students; 15 helpdesk staff across 5 departments plus triage). **Sponsor:** Dean of Student Affairs. **Original request:** "Buy an AI chatbot because tickets take forever." **FDE reframing:** find where the time actually goes first.

Stakeholders

Who	Role in problem	What they want
Dean of Student Affairs	Sponsor, owns the KPI	Fewer complaints; a defensible decision on the chatbot spend
Helpdesk Manager	Operational owner	Know which queue or step is slow; fair workload
Triage coordinators (2)	Route email/'Other' tickets	Less manual sorting
Department agents (IT, Hostel, Finance, Academics, Library)	Resolve tickets	Receive only tickets that belong to them
Students	Affected users	Fast, first-time-right resolution; visibility
IT admin	Owns ticketing tool data	No disruption to the tool

Current workflow (where the problem appears)



Before the problem: intake and categorisation decide the first queue. After the problem: students chase with follow-ups, reopen tickets and give low CSAT.

Problem statement (SMART)

Only **63%** of student helpdesk tickets resolved between 27 Jul and 20 Sep 2026 met their priority SLA (High 24h / Medium 72h / Low 120h), and only **21%** of High-priority tickets did. **Identify where in the ticket workflow delay accumulates** and implement the highest-impact process fixes to raise SLA compliance to **≥75%** (High-priority to **≥50%**) **within 8 weeks**, using the **existing helpdesk team and current ticketing tool** (no new hires, no new software).

KPI & supporting metrics

Metric	Baseline
KPI: SLA compliance rate (resolved within priority SLA, net of waiting-on-student)	63.1%
M1 Median time to first response	17.9h
M2 Median manual-triage wait	13.2h
M3 Reassignment rate	12.4%
M4 Reopen rate	9.4%
M5 Average CSAT (1–5), response rate	3.69 (36%)

Scope

MVP (in): all tickets from the 3 intake channels over 8 weeks; the lifecycle from creation to final resolution; routing, queueing, escalation and reminders; a repeatable pipeline and KPI report.

Out of scope: building or buying the chatbot; staffing and HR changes; agent-level performance ranking; real-time dashboards; changes to the ticketing tool's code.

Success means: the KPI is **≥75%** and High **≥50%** on the same, signed-off definition, with reassignment rate and median first response falling. Early read on leading indicators within 2 weeks of the pilot.

Data: synthetic, realistic (seeded generator). Sources: SQLite ticket DB, CSV audit log, JSON CSAT export, paginated Portal REST API.

2 · What I found

